

Elijah Cassidy

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SUMMARY

Full-stack software engineer and FinOps practitioner with hands-on production experience building cloud cost management platforms, data pipelines, and AI evaluation frameworks at 84.51° (a Kroger data science subsidiary). Progressed from University Co-Op to Lead Developer, owning an internal application that provides visibility into ~\$30M in annual cloud spend. Early AI adopter and invited presenter at internal AI workshops. Pursuing dual B.S. degrees in Software Development and Cybersecurity at the University of Cincinnati (2027).

EXPERIENCE

84.51° (Kroger) — Cincinnati, OH

FinOps Engineering Co-Op / Intern, Tech Optimization / Platform Engineering

Aug. 2024 – Present

- Own and develop the **FinOps Web Application (TechOps App)** — the organization's primary internal tool for cloud cost dashboards, Databricks analytics, storage reporting, contract exploration, and cloud forecasting; used daily by finance, engineering, and leadership teams.
- Architect and maintain a **15+ page Plotly Dash application** (Python/Flask) covering Cloud Cost Breakdown, Cloud Anomaly Report, Cloud Cost Calculator, Contract Explorer, Databricks Tools, DBX Credit Burndown, Forecasting, Savings Dashboard, Storage Report, Tech Spend, AI Eval, User Engagement, and Admin.
- Designed and implemented a **three-tier data architecture**: Databricks Delta Lake → Azure Redis cache → LakeBase PostgreSQL, optimizing read performance and supporting both analytical queries and OLTP writes.
- Manage **30+ Redis-cached data pipelines** with daily/weekly refresh cadences sourcing from Databricks SQL for low-latency dashboard loads.
- Built **role-based access control** using Azure AD / MSAL, reading user roles from a Databricks-backed master table.
- Designed and deployed multiple **LakeBase PostgreSQL schemas** (`finops`, `agent_eval`, `cloud_anomaly`, `tech_optimization`) with full DDL, migrations, views, and grants across TST/DEV/PRD environments.
- Designed and implemented a **3-pillar AI Evaluation Framework** to objectively score enterprise AI tools (Copilot, Glean, Claude, Gemini): User Feedback (40%), Chat Benchmark (30%), Agent Eval (30%) — with 15+ database objects and a full 5-tab CRUD UI.
- Led a **full codebase refactor** of the multi-page Dash app: reduced main page files from 800–1,300 lines to 50–285 lines (thin orchestrators); created 16 `__init__.py` files and 9 callback modules; enforced anti-circular-import architecture.
- Authored a **Dash/Streamlit deployment guide on Stack Overflow for Teams** (978 views); co-created the official **Dash app template variant** for the internal BOB scaffolding tool used by teams deploying to AKS.

- Identified as an **early AI adopter**; invited presenter at the **Tech Operations AI Workshop** on integrating AI tooling into developer workflows.
- Part of a team that delivered **\$6.9M+ in cloud optimization savings in FY24** and **\$7.5M+ annualized** through Spot Instance adoption, storage tiering, and Databricks efficiency.

Software Development Co-Op, University of Cincinnati Medical Lab

Nov. 2023 – 2024

- Built a full-stack GUI application enabling lab members to access back-end protein generation programs via API calls to a high-powered computing cluster.
- Assisted in full-stack development of molecular dynamics pipelines using Python, React, Flask, JavaScript, and HTML.
- Curated large datasets through development of specialized scripts; installed and managed software on a Linux HPC environment.

KEY PROJECTS

FinOps Web Application (TechOps App)

Python · Plotly Dash · Flask · Databricks SQL · PostgreSQL · Azure Redis · Azure AD · AKS

- Central FinOps platform used daily by ~20+ stakeholders; 15+ pages covering cost breakdowns, anomaly detection, calculators, contract management, Databricks optimization, forecasting, savings tracking, and admin controls.

AI Evaluation Framework

Python · Plotly Dash · PostgreSQL · Databricks

- 3-pillar scoring system (User Feedback / Chat Benchmark / Agent Eval) evaluating Copilot, Glean, Claude, and Gemini against shared rubrics; full schema with computed pillar scores (GENERATED ALWAYS AS ... STORED), aggregation views, and seed utilities.

Cloud Cost Calculator

Python · Plotly Dash · Azure VM Pricing APIs

- Converted a complex Excel model into a production web app estimating costs for Databricks, Snowflake, and AKS; surfaces Azure VM pricing with org-specific discount rates; encourages SPOT adoption (up to 85% compute savings).

Forecasting App

Power Apps · Power Automate · Teams

- Automated cloud spend forecasting workflow for Business Domains; saves ~15 meetings (22.5 hrs) per period; Teams-integrated with 48-hour auto-approval logic.

FinOps Tags API

Python · Azure AD · OIDC · JWT

- REST API serving FinOps tagging data to internal consumers with OIDC redirect and JWT bearer token validation for service-to-service auth.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages & Frameworks: Python, SQL, JavaScript, HTML/CSS, Plotly Dash, Flask, React

Cloud & Infrastructure: Microsoft Azure (AKS, Azure AD/Entra ID, ADLS Gen2, Azure Redis, Azure VMs, Azure Policy), Kubernetes, Helm Charts, Terraform, Docker

Data & Analytics: Databricks (Delta Lake, Unity Catalog, Databricks SQL, Jobs, Notebooks), PostgreSQL, Snowflake, Redis, Power BI, Excel (advanced)

Authentication & Security: Azure AD / MSAL, OIDC, JWT Bearer Token Auth, RBAC, Service Principals

DevOps & Collaboration: Git/GitHub, AKS Deployments (BOB), Jira, Confluence, ServiceNow (SciClops API), Datadog

Automation & Integration: Power Apps, Power Automate, Microsoft Teams Integrations, REST APIs

AI & Evaluation: AI tool evaluation framework design, LLM evaluation rubrics, prompt engineering, AI agent architecture, Claude Code

EDUCATION

University of Cincinnati — Cincinnati, OH

Aug. 2023 – Present (Expected Graduation: 2027)

- B.S. Software Development
- B.S. Cybersecurity
- 3.6 GPA | Dean's List

Saint Charles Preparatory High School — Columbus, OH

Aug. 2019 – May 2023

- 3.9 GPA | 16 Honor Roll Awards
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AWARDS & SCHOLARSHIPS

- STEM-DeJaco Scholarship
 - Students in STEM Scholarship
 - Cincinnati Century Scholarship
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VOLUNTEERING

Gospel Road — **Group Leader/Volunteer** | Columbus, OH | *July 2019 – July 2022*

Participated in and helped lead 3 urban missions.

SELECTED ACCOMPLISHMENTS

- Progressed from **Co-Op to Lead Developer** on the Tech Optimization team, owning the primary FinOps platform for the organization.
- Designed the **AI Evaluation Framework** — a 3-pillar system adopted enterprise-wide to evaluate AI tools (Copilot, Glean, Claude, Gemini) with 15+ database objects and full CRUD UI.
- Helped deliver **\$6.9M+ in cloud optimization savings in FY24** (\$7.5M+ annualized).
- Cloud Cost Calculator and Forecasting App together **save 22.5+ hours per period** for Business Domains.
- Authored a deployment guide with **~1,000 views on Stack Overflow for Teams**; co-created the official internal Dash app template for BOB.
- Manage **30+ automated data pipelines** with daily/weekly refresh cadences serving real-time dashboards.
- Invited presenter at the **Tech Operations AI Workshop** on AI tooling and developer workflows.